NISR · RWANDA VITAL STATISTICS 2019–2025

Counted at birth. Missing at death.

Rwanda now registers **9 in 10 births**, but only about **1 in 2 deaths**. In 2025 about **38,500 deaths** never reached the official record.

BIRTHS REGISTERED, 2025

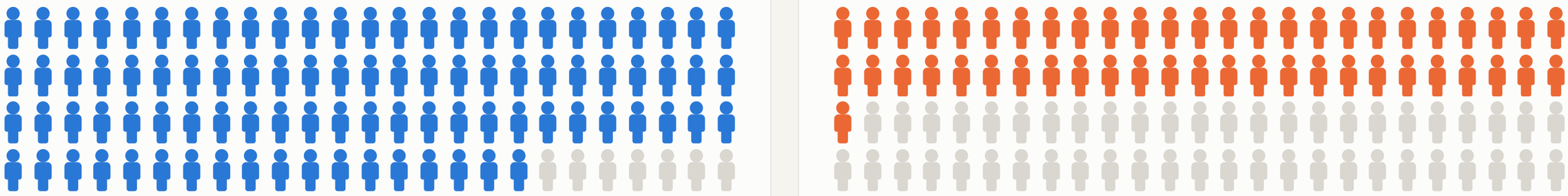
92.9%

356,838 registered of 384,279 expected births

DEATHS REGISTERED, 2025

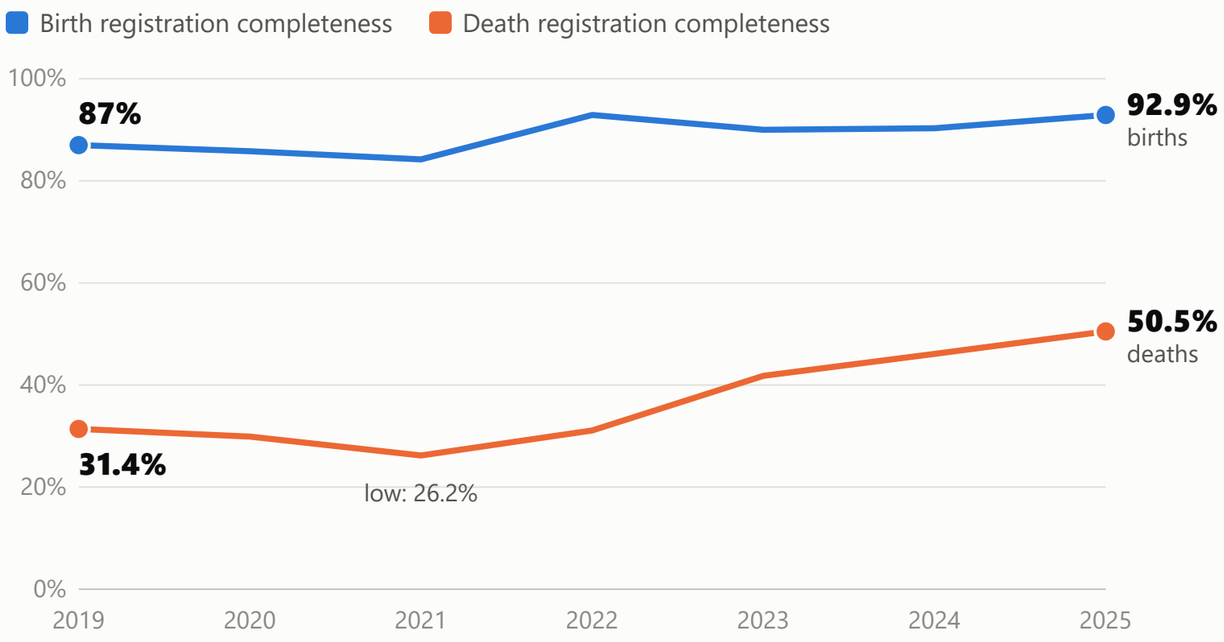
50.5%

39,355 registered of 77,876 expected deaths



1 The death gap is closing, fast

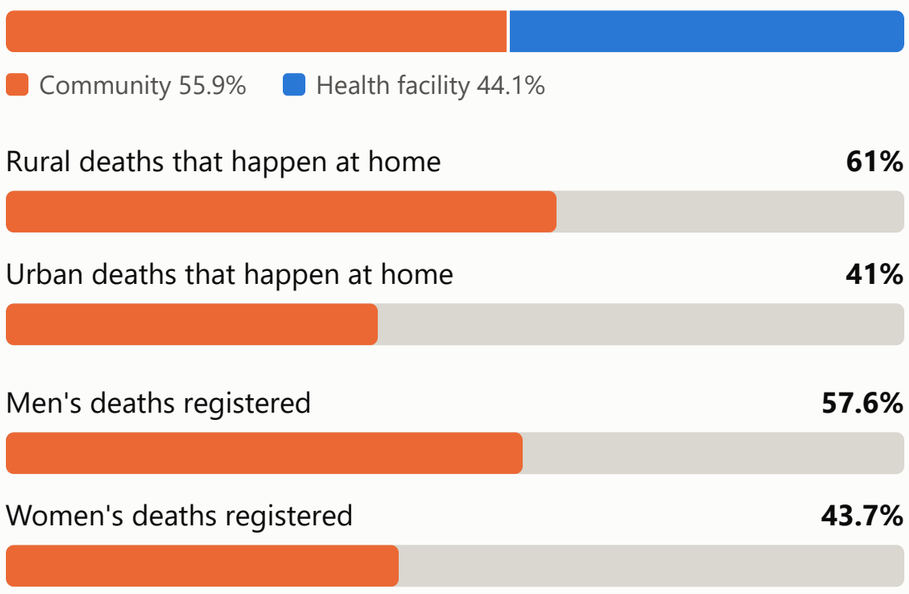
Death registration rose **+19.1 points** since 2019, after a low of 26.2% in 2021.



2 Who is still missing?

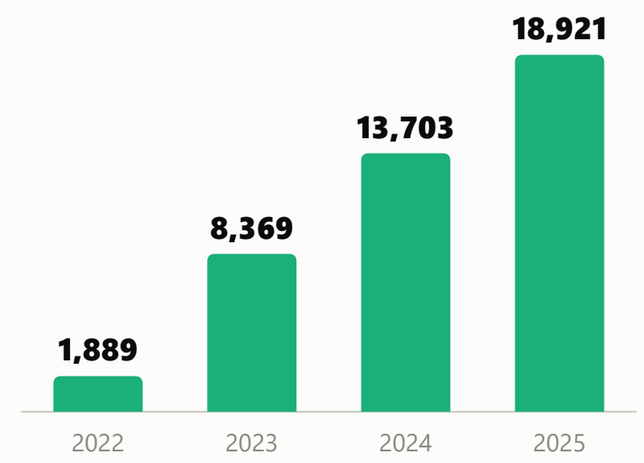
The gap is biggest where people die at home, and for women.

55.9% of deaths happen at home

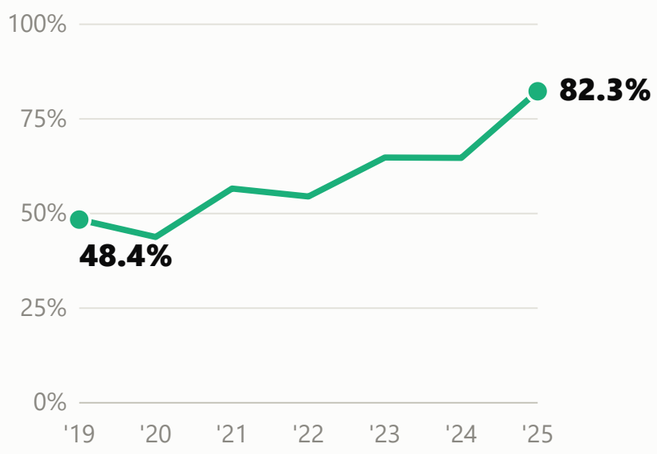


3 What is working

Verbal autopsies, where trained staff ask families how a relative died at home, grew **10×**.

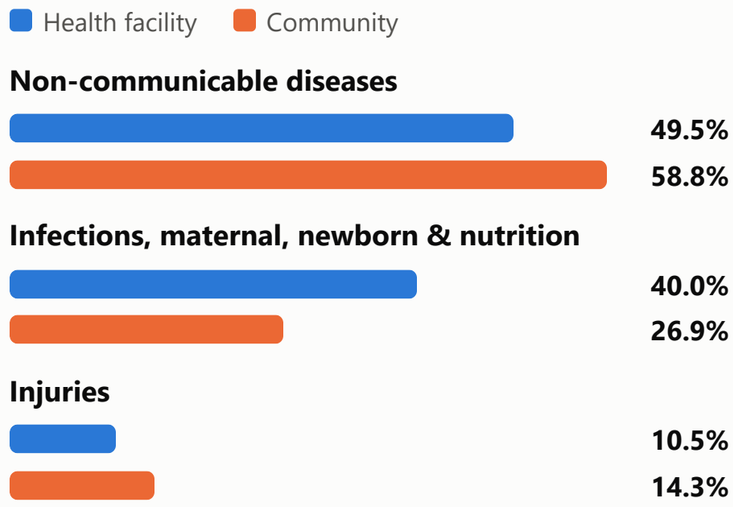


Hospital deaths with a **usable cause** recorded by doctors:



4 Why it matters

Counted deaths show what is killing Rwandans (2025, usable causes):



> **Heart disease** leads at home (16.2% + 11.1%); **newborn conditions** lead in hospitals (14.9%). Neonatal deaths fell **23.5** → **18.7** per 1,000 ↓ 4.8

CLOSE THE GAP

Count every life, from first breath to last.

Families
Register every death within 30 days, especially deaths at home.

Communities
Grow verbal autopsy coverage in rural districts.

Policy makers
Use cause-of-death data to target heart disease and newborn care.

Source: National Institute of Statistics of Rwanda (NISR), *Rwanda Vital Statistics Report 2025* Final Tables (CRVS 2025): Tables 10.3, 10.8, 12, 14, 16, 17; Figures 17, 21, 24, 25; 2025 fact sheets. statistics.gov.rw. "About 38,500" (77,876 − 39,355), "+19.1 points" and "10×" (18,921 ÷ 1,889) are our calculations from NISR figures.

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